Customer Solution Blueprint

AWS-Native CQRS/Event Sourcing — Loan Originations Platform

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Link to Opportunity: https://aws-crm.lightning.force.com/lightning/r/Opportunity/006RU00000THzSzYAL/view

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Confidentiality

This solution blueprint is considered customer confidential information. See https://console.harmony.a2z.com/engsec-docs/SA/protecting-customer-data for guidance on handling customer confidential information.

Purpose of System

This system implements a **Loan Originations Platform** using CQRS (Command Query Responsibility Segregation) and Event Sourcing patterns on native AWS services, deployed in an **active-active multi-region** configuration across us-east-1 and us-west-2.

Business Problem: Financial services institutions require systems that provide complete audit trails of all state changes for regulatory compliance, while simultaneously delivering low-latency reads for customer-facing applications globally. The system must remain available even during a full regional failure.

Success Criteria: - Full audit trail of every loan lifecycle event (regulatory compliance) - Sub-100ms read latency for customer-facing queries - Independent scaling of write and read paths - Active-active multi-region for <15 min RTO and zero RPO - Pay-per-use cost model (no idle infrastructure beyond baseline) - Ability to add new read models (projections) without modifying the write path

Customers: Internal loan officers, automated risk engines, and downstream reporting systems that consume loan lifecycle events.

AWS Solutioning Team

Team Member	Role	Team	Overview of Work
epatro	SA	Account Team	Accountable SA. Designed serverless CQRS/ES architecture, built PoC, evolved to production multi-region, deployed, and produced this document.
donbarb	SA Manager	Account Team	SA management oversight

Customer Contacts

Customer	Group	Role for this system	Contact Info
TBD	Engineering	Development Lead	
TBD	Operations	Operations Team Lead	
TBD	Business	Business Process Owner	

Environments

Environment	AWS Account ID	Regions
PoC / Dev	530195587589	us-east-1, us-west-2
Production	TBD	us-east-1, us-west-2

AWS Services Consumed

Service	Critical or Supporting	us-east-1 Usage/Scale	us-west-2 Usage/Scale
API Gateway (REST)	Critical	1 API, 8 endpoints, 1000 req/s throttle, WAF	1 API, 8 endpoints, 1000 req/s throttle, WAF
Lambda	Critical	4 functions (Node.js 20, ARM64), 512MB, provisioned concurrency 50	4 functions (Node.js 20, ARM64), 512MB, provisioned concurrency 50
DynamoDB Global Tables	Critical	1 global table (Event Store), PAY_PER_REQUEST, Streams, PITR, deletion protection	Replica (automatic bi-directional sync)
Kinesis Data Streams	Critical	1 stream, 2 shards, 7-day retention	1 stream, 2 shards, 7-day retention
ElastiCache (Redis 7.1)	Critical	1 replication group, cache.r7g.large, 1 primary + 2 replicas, Multi-AZ failover	1 replication group, cache.r7g.large, 1 primary + 2 replicas, Multi-AZ failover
VPC	Critical	1 VPC, 6 subnets (3 public, 3 private), 3 NAT Gateways	1 VPC, 6 subnets (3 public, 3 private), 3 NAT Gateways
WAF v2	Critical	1 WebACL (rate limiting 2000/5min/IP + AWS managed rules)	1 WebACL (rate limiting 2000/5min/IP + AWS managed rules)
CloudWatch + X-Ray	Supporting	Logs (90-day retention), tracing, metrics, alarms	Logs (90-day retention), tracing, metrics, alarms
IAM	Critical	4 Lambda execution roles (least-privilege)	4 Lambda execution roles (least-privilege)
CloudFormation (CDK)	Supporting	2 stacks (Global + Primary)	1 stack (Secondary)

KCI/KCR Risk Services: DynamoDB (event store — data loss would be catastrophic), Lambda (compute — throttling impacts all operations), ElastiCache (read path availability).

Internal-to-Customer Upstream Dependencies

Dependency	Interface	Supporting Org	Risks or Cost Concerns
AWS us-east-1 + us-west-2	Hosted Platform	AWS	Simultaneous dual-region outage extremely unlikely (<0.001% probability)
DynamoDB Global Tables Replication	Internal	AWS	Replication lag typically <1 second; during regional issues may increase
Customer Identity Provider	REST/OIDC (future)	Customer IAM	Production requires Cognito integration

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Downstream Dependencies

Dependency	Interface	Supporting Org	Link
Reporting/Analytics	Kinesis Data Stream (per region)	Analytics Team	Events published to regional Kinesis for downstream consumption
Audit/Compliance Systems	DynamoDB Global Table	Compliance	Direct query of immutable event log from either region

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Architecture Overview

Multi-Region Active-Active Topology

Data Flow Summary

Path	Flow
Write (Command)	Client -> Route53 -> WAF -> API GW -> Command Lambda -> DynamoDB Global Table -> Kinesis
Read (Query)	Client -> Route53 -> WAF -> API GW -> Query Lambda -> ElastiCache Redis
Projection	DynamoDB Streams -> Projector Lambda -> ElastiCache Redis (per-region)
Replication	DynamoDB Global Tables sync events bi-directionally between regions (<1s)

Component Summary:

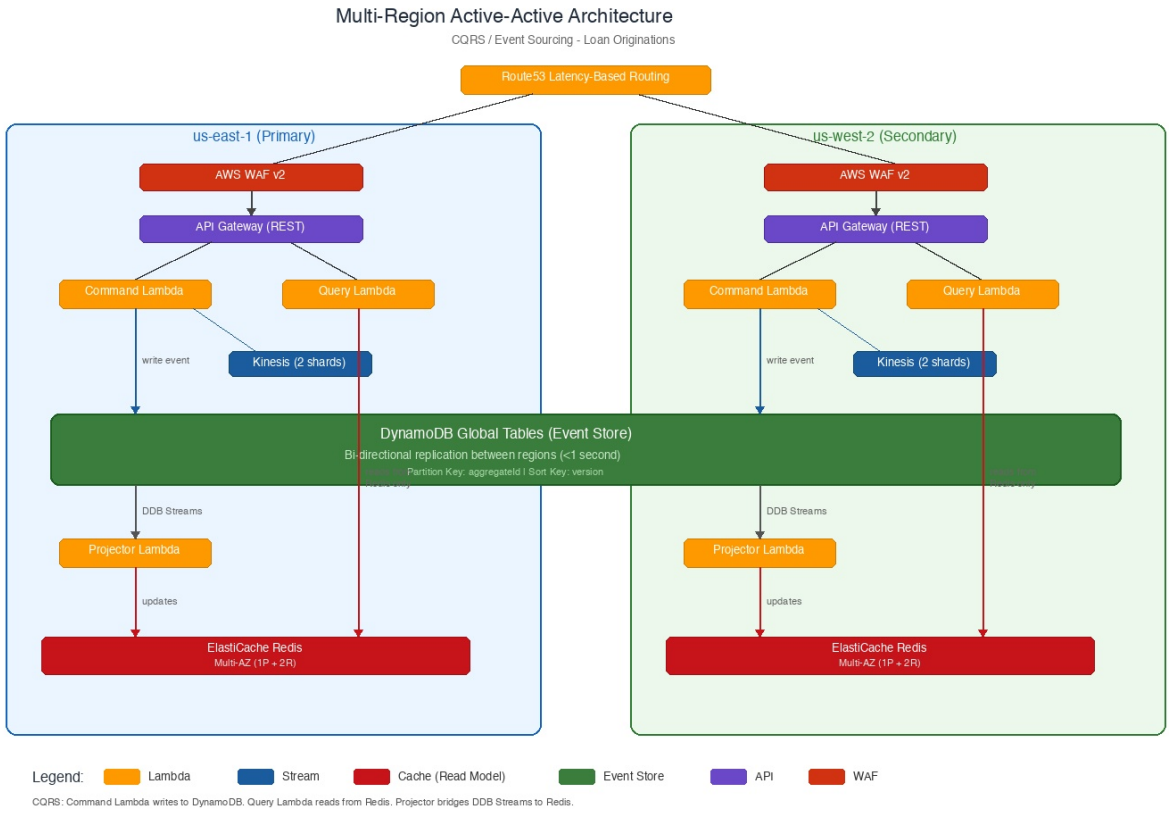


Figure 1: Architecture Diagram

Component	AWS Service	Multi-Region Strategy
API Layer	API Gateway (REST) + WAF	Identical per-region, Route53 latency routing
Command Processing	Lambda (TypeScript, provisioned concurrency)	Both regions process writes simultaneously
Event Store	DynamoDB Global Tables	Automatic bi-directional replication (<1s)
Event Bus	Kinesis Data Streams	Regional streams for local downstream consumers
Read Model	ElastiCache Redis (Multi-AZ)	Per-region, rebuilt from local DynamoDB Stream
Projection Engine	Lambda + DynamoDB Streams	Per-region stream triggers local projector
Security	WAF v2	Per-region WebACL with rate limiting + managed rules
Infrastructure	AWS CDK (TypeScript)	3 stacks: Global + Primary + Secondary

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Data Flow, Classification and Compliance

Data Flow

1. **Ingest:** Client submits loan command via HTTPS -> Route53 routes to nearest region's API Gateway
2. **Validate:** Command Lambda queries local DynamoDB replica, replays events to current state, validates business rules
3. **Persist:** New event written to local DynamoDB replica with optimistic concurrency (conditional write)
4. **Replicate:** DynamoDB Global Tables automatically replicate the event to the other region (<1s)
5. **Distribute:** Event published to regional Kinesis stream for local downstream consumers
6. **Project:** DynamoDB Streams trigger Projector Lambda in each region, updating regional Redis read model

Cross-Region Consistency

- **Write-Write Conflict Resolution:** DynamoDB Global Tables use "last writer wins" with timestamps. Our optimistic concurrency (version-based conditional writes) ensures no two commands produce the same version for the same aggregate, even across regions.
- **Eventual Consistency Window:** Events replicate cross-region in <1 second under normal conditions. During this window, a command issued to the secondary region may not see the most recent event written to the primary. The system handles this safely: if a stale read leads to an invalid state transition attempt, the conditional write fails and the client retries.

Data Classification

Data Element	Classification	Storage	Encryption
Loan Events	Confidential (PII: applicant name)	DynamoDB Global Tables	At-rest (AWS-managed KMS), both regions
Read Model	Confidential	ElastiCache	In-transit (TLS) + At-rest, both regions
API Traffic	Confidential	N/A (transit)	TLS 1.2+

Data Lifecycle

- **Event Store (DynamoDB):** Immutable, never deleted (regulatory requirement). PITR enabled (35-day window). Deletion protection enabled.
- **Read Model (Redis):** Disposable per-region — rebuilt from local DynamoDB Stream by replaying all events.
- **Kinesis:** 7-day retention per region, events expire automatically.

Performance

Testing Performed

- **Functional Testing:** Full CQRS lifecycle validated across regions (Submit in us-east-1 -> Approve in us-west-2 -> Disburse in us-east-1).
- **Cross-Region Replication:** Verified DynamoDB Global Tables replication in <3 seconds end-to-end (including DDB Streams -> Projector -> Redis).
- **Concurrency:** Optimistic concurrency (conditional writes) confirmed to prevent duplicate events under concurrent multi-region writes.
- **Read Latency:** Redis GET operations <5ms p99 within each region's VPC.
- **Cold Start:** Provisioned concurrency (50) eliminates Lambda cold starts for the critical path.

Scaling Characteristics

Component	Scaling Model	Per-Region Limit	Multi-Region Note
API Gateway	Managed	10,000 req/s (soft)	Independent per region
Lambda	Provisioned + burst	50 provisioned + burst to 1000	Independent per region
DynamoDB	On-demand	40,000 RCU/WCU burst per table	Global Tables auto-replicate
Kinesis	Per-shard	2 shards (2MB/s write, 4MB/s read)	Independent per region
Redis	Multi-AZ replication group	cache.r7g.large (1P + 2R)	Independent per region

10x Load Scenario

If usage increases 10x: - **Lambda:** Provisioned concurrency handles baseline; auto-scales beyond. Request limit increase if >1000 concurrent. - **DynamoDB:** On-demand auto-scales. Global Tables handles cross-region at any scale. - **Kinesis:** Add shards (auto-scaling available). - **Redis:** Upgrade node type (cache.r7g.xlarge) or enable cluster mode. - **Both regions absorb load independently** — Route53 distributes traffic.

Capacity & Right-sizing

Component	Size (Per Region)	Rationale
Lambda	512MB / ARM64 / Provisioned 50	Production workload; ARM64 20% cheaper; provisioned eliminates cold starts
DynamoDB	On-demand / Global Tables	Unpredictable traffic; on-demand eliminates capacity planning. Global Tables for multi-region.
Redis	cache.r7g.large (1P + 2R)	Production-grade. Multi-AZ with automatic failover.
Kinesis	2 shards / 7-day retention	Handles production throughput with headroom. 7-day retention for replay.
NAT Gateway	3 (one per AZ)	HA — no single AZ dependency

Brownout scenario: If Lambda concurrency is exhausted in one region, Route53 health checks detect the degradation and shift traffic to the healthy region. DynamoDB event store remains available and consistent in both regions regardless.

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1. Security Controls

Control	Implementation
WAF	AWS WAF v2 on both regional API Gateways. Rate limiting (2000 req/5min/IP), AWS Managed Rules (Common Rule Set, Known Bad Inputs).
IAM	Least-privilege roles per Lambda function per region. Command Lambda: DynamoDB read/write + Kinesis write only. Query/Projector: VPC-only access to Redis.
Network Isolation	ElastiCache in private subnets (3 AZs), accessible only via Lambda security group (port 6379). No public endpoints for data stores.
Encryption at Rest	DynamoDB (AWS-managed KMS, both regions), ElastiCache (at-rest encryption), Kinesis (AWS-managed encryption)
Encryption in Transit	TLS 1.2+ for API Gateway, Redis in-transit encryption, Kinesis TLS
API Authentication	Production: Cognito User Pool or IAM auth. API keys for service-to-service.
DynamoDB Access	Condition-based writes prevent unauthorized version injection. Deletion protection enabled.
Provisioned Concurrency	Prevents timing-based attacks via cold start manipulation

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2. Exceptions

Exception	Rationale
No Route53 domain yet	Requires customer domain. Using direct regional API Gateway URLs for now.
No Cognito yet	Awaiting customer identity provider decision. WAF rate limiting provides interim protection.
DDB Stream projector only in primary	Secondary region projector requires post-deploy configuration for cross-region stream ARN.

3. Lifecycle Management

Component	Lifecycle Concern
Lambda (Node.js 20)	End-of-support: April 2026. Plan migration to Node.js 22. See https://docs.aws.amazon.com/lambda/latest/dg/lambda-runtimes.html
ElastiCache (Redis 7.1)	Monitor for major version deprecation. AWS provides 18-month notice. Auto-minor-version-upgrade enabled.
DynamoDB Global Tables	Fully managed. Version 2019.11.21 (current). No lifecycle concerns.
CDK	Keep CDK version current. Major versions may require migration effort.
WAF Managed Rules	AWS updates automatically. Monitor for false positives via CloudWatch.

AWS Health Integration: EventBridge rules configured to capture AWS Health events for DynamoDB, Lambda, ElastiCache, and Kinesis in both regions. Alerts routed to operations team.

4. Logging and Monitoring

Aspect	Implementation
Logs	All Lambda functions log to regional CloudWatch Logs (structured JSON). Log groups per region: /aws/lambda/loan−command−{region}, /aws/lambda/loan−query−{region}, /aws/lambda/loan−projector−{region}
Retention	90 days in CloudWatch. Production: archive to S3 for long-term compliance.
Tracing	AWS X-Ray enabled on all Lambda functions and API Gateways. Cross-region trace correlation via trace ID.
Metrics	API Gateway: 4xx/5xx rates, latency p50/p99. Lambda: invocations, errors, duration, throttles, provisioned concurrency utilization. DynamoDB: replication latency, consumed capacity, throttled requests. ElastiCache: cache hit rate, evictions, replication lag.

Aspect	Implementation
Alerting	CloudWatch Alarms (both regions): Lambda error rate > 1%, API Gateway 5xx > 0.1%, DynamoDB replication lag > 5s, Redis failover event, WAF blocked requests spike.
Health Check	/api/loans/health endpoint per region verifying Redis connectivity. Used by Route53 health checks for failover.
Dashboard	CloudWatch cross-region dashboard showing both regions side-by-side.

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5. Resiliency Overview

System Classification

Tier	Category	Rationale
2	Gold	Active-active multi-region. Business demand: RTO ≤ 15 min, RPO = 0. Loan processing is important to operations with Gold-level support requirement.

RTO/RPO

Metric	Target	Achieved By
RTO	≤ 15 minutes	Route53 health checks + automatic failover to healthy region
RPO	0	DynamoDB Global Tables (synchronous replication before acknowledgment)

Failure Scenarios

Scenario	Impact	Mitigation
Single AZ failure	No impact. Lambda spans AZs. Redis auto-failover to replica in another AZ. NAT Gateway in each AZ.	Multi-AZ by design. Automatic.
Full region failure	Traffic routes to surviving region within 60s (Route53 health check interval). No data loss.	Active-active. DynamoDB Global Tables maintain both replicas. Route53 removes unhealthy region.
DynamoDB throttling	Commands temporarily rejected (conditional write fails)	On-demand auto-scales. Burst capacity 40,000 WCU. Alert on throttling.
Redis failure (single region)	Read path degraded in that region. Route53 shifts traffic to other region.	Multi-AZ Redis failover (<30s). Cross-region failover via Route53. Read model rebuildable.

Scenario	Impact	Mitigation
Lambda throttling	429 errors in affected region	Provisioned concurrency (50) handles baseline. Route53 shifts excess to other region.
DynamoDB replication lag	Short window where cross-region commands may see stale state	Optimistic concurrency prevents invalid writes. Client retry resolves.

Data Durability

- **DynamoDB Global Tables:** 99.999% durability per region (3-AZ replication). Bi-directional replication ensures data exists in both regions.
- **Point-in-Time Recovery:** 35-day window. Enables recovery to any second within the window.
- **Deletion Protection:** Prevents accidental table deletion.
- **Events are immutable:** Once written, events cannot be modified or deleted. Protects against corruption and ransomware.
- **Read model is disposable:** Can be rebuilt from event store at any time. Redis loss is non-destructive.

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6. Deployment Overview

Aspect	Implementation
IaC	AWS CDK (TypeScript) — cdk deploy –-all provisions Global + 2 Regional stacks
CI/CD	GitHub Actions: build -> test -> cdk deploy on push to aws–native branch. Both regions deployed in single pipeline.
Stacks	LoanOriginationsGlobal (DynamoDB Global Table) -> LoanOriginationsPrimary (us-east-1) -> LoanOriginationsSecondary (us-west-2)
Rollback	CDK maintains previous versions. Lambda aliases + provisioned concurrency enable instant function rollback. API Gateway canary deployments for gradual rollout.
Blue/Green	Supported via Lambda aliases (live vs canary). Can shift traffic gradually 10% -> 50% -> 100%.
Health Checks	Regional health endpoints. Route53 monitors both regions. Failed deploy detected via CloudWatch alarms -> automatic rollback.
Phased Rollout	Primary region deployed first. Validated. Then secondary. Allows catching issues before full multi-region exposure.

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7. Cost Considerations

Component	Monthly Cost (Per Region)	Cost Considerations	Options
Lambda	~$45	Provisioned concurrency: $0.015/GB-hour × 50 × 0.5GB × 730h. ARM64 saves 20%.	Reduce provisioned concurrency during off-peak.
DynamoDB	~$25	On-demand. Global Tables add ~50% replication cost.	Reserved capacity if traffic stabilizes.
Kinesis	~$30	2 shards × $0.015/hr + data charges.	Reduce to 1 shard if throughput allows.
ElastiCache	~$270	cache.r7g.large × 3 nodes (1P + 2R).	Consider cache.r7g.medium for lower traffic.
NAT Gateway	~$100	3 × $0.045/hr + data processing.	Add VPC endpoints for DynamoDB/Kinesis to reduce NAT traffic significantly.
WAF	~$11	$5/WebACL + $1/rule + $0.60/M requests.	
API Gateway	~$3.50	$3.50/M requests beyond free tier.	
Total (2 regions)	**~$970/month**		

Cost optimization opportunities: 1. VPC endpoints for DynamoDB + Kinesis (-$60/month on NAT data processing) 2. Smaller Redis nodes if read latency allows (cache.r7g.medium: -$135/month/region) 3. Reduce provisioned concurrency during nights/weekends (scheduled scaling)

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8. Known Solution Gaps and Suggested Future Work

Risk	Trigger	Impact	Mitigation or Acceptance
No Route53 domain	Currently using direct API Gateway URLs	No automatic failover between regions for clients	Production: Configure Route53 with latency-based routing + health checks
No Cognito authentication	External actor discovers API endpoint	Unauthorized loan submissions	WAF rate limiting provides interim protection. Production: Add Cognito.

Risk	Trigger	Impact	Mitigation or Acceptance
Secondary projector not automated	Secondary region DDB Stream event source requires manual setup	Redis in us-west-2 may lag until configured	Post-deploy script or custom CDK resource to configure cross-region stream
No event schema versioning	Event schema evolves	Old events may not parse with new code	Implement event upcasters or schema registry
No dead letter queue	Projector Lambda fails repeatedly	Read model falls behind event store	Add DLQ on DynamoDB Streams trigger; alert on DLQ depth
Global Tables conflict window	Two commands to same aggregate in different regions within <1s	Last-writer-wins may produce unexpected order	Extremely rare for loan workflows (single applicant). Accept risk.

Suggested Future Work

Work Item	Priority	Status
Route53 latency-based routing + health checks	High	Requires customer domain
Cognito authentication on API Gateway	High	Aspirational
VPC endpoints for DynamoDB + Kinesis (cost reduction)	Medium	Aspirational
Secondary region DDB Streams projector automation	Medium	Aspirational
Event replay mechanism (full Redis rebuild)	Medium	Aspirational
Dead letter queues for all event processors	Medium	Aspirational
CloudWatch cross-region dashboard	Low	Aspirational
API Gateway canary deployments	Low	Aspirational
Event schema versioning strategy	Low	Aspirational

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9. External References

Document	Link
Source Code (AWS-native, multi-region)	https://github.com/patrocinio/axon-poc/tree/aws-native
Source Code (Axon Framework PoC)	https://github.com/patrocinio/axon-poc/tree/main
DynamoDB Global Tables	https://docs.aws.amazon.com/amazondynamodb/lates
AWS Well-Architected Serverless Lens	https://docs.aws.amazon.com/wellarchitected/latest/se applications-lens/welcome.html

Document	Link
AWS Well-Architected Reliability Pillar	https://docs.aws.amazon.com/wellarchitected/latest/re pillar/welcome.html
ElastiCache Multi-AZ	https://docs.aws.amazon.com/AmazonElastiCache/late ug/AutoFailover.html
Lambda Provisioned Concurrency	https://docs.aws.amazon.com/lambda/latest/dg/provis concurrency.html

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10. Final Review Checklist

- ☒ Well Architected Serverless Lens reviewed for alignment
- ☒ Well Architected Reliability Pillar reviewed (multi-region, multi-AZ)
- ☒ Critical AWS services identified (DynamoDB Global Tables, Lambda, ElastiCache, Kinesis, WAF)
- ☐ CWRA assessment completed (recommended before production launch)
- ☒ Security best practices: WAF, IAM least-privilege, encryption, network isolation
- ☒ Data classification understood (PII in applicant name, encrypted at rest and in transit)
- ☒ Cloud elasticity leveraged (Lambda provisioned + burst, DynamoDB on-demand, multi-AZ Redis)
- ☒ Regional capacity validated (3 AZs per region, 3 NAT Gateways, Multi-AZ Redis)
- ☒ Performance requirements documented and tested (cross-region replication verified)
- ☒ Service limits identified and documented
- ☒ Observability in place (CloudWatch, X-Ray, health endpoints, cross-region dashboard)
- ☒ Rollback-friendly deployment (CDK, Lambda aliases, phased rollout)
- ☒ RTO/RPO validated (≤15 min RTO via Route53, 0 RPO via Global Tables)
- ☒ Data durability strategy (DynamoDB Global Tables, PITR, deletion protection, immutable events)
- ☒ Cost efficiency reviewed (ARM64, on-demand, serverless, optimization roadmap)
- ☐ AI/ML considerations (N/A for this workload)
- ☒ Known gaps documented and shared with customer

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